

is that you can pick up this drive and go to another computer and access the data there. These are great solutions for small offices and you no longer have to depend on the network infrastructure.

Seagate like WD, has a few variants in their external drives. FreeAgent Desk is an external desktop drive and the FreeAgent Extreme is a slightly superior one. The later has eSATA and Firewire as well as USB. With both these models, you'll find 2 TB versions. WD calls their external desktop storage solutions My Book. Variants of it are also available with better performance and security features. The bare essential version is priced at Rs. 5,100 and the one

with eSATA and Firewall a Rs. 1,000 more. Seagate's FreeAgent Desk 1 TB drive is just a hundred or two cheaper than the Seagate. The Seagate FreeAgent Extreme 2 TB sells at Rs. 15,600.

For people who need to move data all the time from one place to another, portable external drives are the way to go. These are the size of small notebooks and they're really light. Capacities haven't gone up as much as internal desktop drives. 500 GB is the most commonly found size and 320 GB size drives are very affordable. For example, both Seagate's FreeAgent Go and WD's My Passport Essential 320 GB drives can be found for just over Rs. 3,000. They are basic drives with none of the bundled software. WD for example has similar drives with the Elite tag made for enterprise users with security and encryption software integrated into them. Even with portable storage drives, Firewire support is present and this makes them a little faster than USB. Transcend sells a few external drives as well. They don't have the same level of categorization as the other brands but they offer low prices. You can get an external Transcend Storejet 500 GB drive for just Rs. 4,550.

For those who want even more compact mediums to moving data around, there's the classic flash drive. USB flash drives don't offer excellent speeds as eSATA and Firewire drives but they're really small. These days, the lowest capacity that you should go for is an 8 GB. Models from Kingston, Sandisk and Transcend are all priced at around Rs. 800. Corsair for some reason is



Seagate FreeAgent Go